

Balancing Trade & Altruism for a Stronger India & Kinder World

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A socio-economic visionary, Dr Anil Kumar, Founder & CEO, Ankita Group of Companies, New Delhi, is renowned as a leader of trading industry and his relentless philanthropic initiatives. He is passionate about nurturing girl child, adolescents and women, besides awakening and empowering India's resilient spirit of an Atma Nirbhar Bharat.



Dr Anil Kumar
Founder & CEO
Ankita Group of Companies, New Delhi

As an industry leader, what has guided your vision to empower the export sector that contributes towards strengthening the Indian economy?

India's advantage is its young population, besides gaining from tremendous experience of our industry leaders. Most importantly, we have to change the mind-set from job seekers to job creators. To share an example, during the Covid pandemic, Bagaha, a nondescript village in Champaran district of Bihar faced a peculiar challenge. Most of the male population in that village had succumbed to the lethal virus leaving behind women folk and children in utter destitution. I received a call for help, which I did a couple of times. But a permanent solution was needed to address the issue. That region was known for rope-making, an opportunity I spotted, and assured them of one time investment on raw material if they took-up making rope. I feel proud to say that today those women are self-reliant and economically independent. I think this cooperative concept can be replicated in every village, small towns and cities, where each cooperative can create jobs for many more. That would truly make India Atma Nirbhar.

How have you linked your business experience with social responsibility?

Through my personal interaction with people in underdeveloped areas, I have realised that the Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana for empowering the needy youth and women through skilling and linking them with the nation's development process is a very novel initiative. I have applied some space to train girls in their area of interest and then support such start-ups in backward states. Recently, the Indian Government offered me two options of developing skill and training centres in Maharashtra and Odisha. I desire to be in Delhi's neighbourhood, or in Bihar, where I belong from,

so as to devote more time for such projects. My dream is that in every part of our country, every daughter and son gets skilled and we support their start-up growth. If every individual becomes self-reliant it will build a prosperous society and make India stronger.

What is the initiative that you are currently focused on through your philanthropic Foundation?

Under the aegis of the Maheshwar Laxmi Memorial Foundation, we have planned a unique initiative of providing nutritious, organic food for pregnant mothers during their full 9 month's term. Drawing from the ancient Ayurveda knowledge system, 9 different food supplements have been developed under the guidance of Aayushman Bharat Committee. Based out of Bengaluru, Karnataka, to begin with, we will take up one state, the most backward, for distribution of nutritional kits through Anganwadis and girls of our Skill India Centres. The nutrition kit will have a nominal cost to it for ensuring affordability, creating better awareness and discourage its misuse. Eventually, we wish to distribute the kit free of cost. A healthy nation begins from the womb of a healthy mother. This is my mission and the launch of this initiative is planned in the new fiscal in April 2026.

How do you see India and its young entrepreneurs' future on the global trade platform?

Every region across our country has something outstandingly indigenous to offer to the world. If we are able to identify these unique resources and tap the opportunities through skilling, training and marketing support for export to the world, it will not only generate employment, attract investors and revenue, but make the nation socio-economically stronger.

We have failed to recognise rural India's indigenous wealth and utilise them to our full advantage, but the government's far sightedness has spotted such opportunities. For example, in the entire world, the best quality Fox nut or Makhana, popularly known as locally, is an acknowledged super food, which is cultivated only in a particular region in North Bihar. When people came to know of its immense nutritional value the demand soared world-wide that the Bihar government set-up a Makhana Board. The cost of Makhana shot up from a measly Rs 100-150 per kilogram to an exorbitant Rs. 1500-2000 per kg. Similarly, by giving focus to such indigenous products, plenty of opportunities covering a wide spectrum from cultivation, processing, manufacturing, packaging, including export, can be explored in different countries of the world.

Which are the new global markets that you desire to establish trade with?

President Trump's heavy tariff levies has impacted exporters like us and even its citizens resulting in

the buying capacity to plummet and double costs. Despite the unfair US tariffs, our export turnover rose significantly from Rs 500 to Rs 700 crores in the current fiscal. We were agile to anticipate the consequences of this US traffic and shifted our focus to CIS countries that includes Russia and the Middle East, which are very good markets from raw to finished products, also organic fruits and foods, where our presence can be further expanded and consolidated. Even Europe is a good market, but the geopolitical situation is unpredictable. Our relations with Afghanistan is also improving because they are dependent on food items and medicines from India, which is known as the pharmacy of the world. Africa, though a smaller market, is very good for trading. Our exports go to Dubai from where it is distributed to African countries, the reason why Dubai is called the Gateway to Africa. Even South-east Asian market is very promising. Quality, punctuality and commitment are non-negotiable for us that ensures customer loyalty.

Maintaining the supply chain is a big challenge. What is the government support that you need as of now?

Logistics is one big issue that traders like us face even today, resulting in delayed availability of freezer containers, which are few in numbers and the costs steep. As of today, we need ease of doing business to prevent delay of any sort in supply chain especially for perishable items, which inflict huge financial loss and burden on us, also it cuts a sorry figure in front of our customers for failing to meet timely commitment of delivery. We have raised this issue on all the trade and commerce platforms be it CII, FICCI but the assurances given are yet to be translated on ground. My humble request to the Central government and respective departments is to look into this matter seriously so that traders don't feel harassed and trade is strengthened. Also, by going GLOCAL, migrations from villages to cosmopolitan cities and even abroad will reduce significantly.

The day this happens, I can say with full conviction, India would be unstoppable from becoming a world economic power. I draw inspiration from the famous quote of Swami Vivekananda - "Arise, awake, and stop not till the goal is reached."

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